

PROSE-DENSITY CONTRACT

# Budget the words.

*Every layout declares how many words each element gets — so the author writes tight, and the reviewer flags the wall of text before it ships.*

# The right layout, with far too many words.

## Wrong shape

Phase 1 already steers which layout, and how many elements.

## Right shape, wrong words

Each card carries a paragraph, not a clause.

## The result

The slide overflows, and the room stops reading.

## KEY INSIGHT

Count is solved. Density is the verbosity left over once the count is right.

# Two budgets, one axis.

## Capacity

How many elements fit — `~4 cards`, past which the grid crowds.

## Density

How many words each element gets — `~15`, past which it overflows.

## Together

Pick the layout by shape; write each element to its word budget.

# How the numbers are set.

## STEP 01

### Seed the target

The aim comes from the canon  
— a label, not a sentence.

## STEP 02

### Clamp the ceiling

Render at rising word counts;  
read where it actually  
overflows.

## STEP 03

### Keep the gap

The target sits well below the  
break — good taste.

# Each row gets a word budget too.

**Owns the scoring model**

Head of Product

One short responsibility, not a job description.

**Runs the weekly review**

Chief of Staff

A clause per row keeps the ledger scannable.

**Maintains the log**

Program Manager

Detail belongs on a follow-up slide, not here.

# The chrome has budgets, regardless of layout.

**Eyebrow**

≤ 5 words

A label that frames, not a sentence that explains.

**Title and subtitle**

≤ 10 · ≤ 12

The takeaway lands in one tight line.

**Key insight and pill**

≤ 18 · ≤ 2

One memorable sentence; a one-word status chip.

# Write tight; the reviewer has your back.

`components.json` carries each layout's `density`; the Drawing Board flags an overrun as a suggestion. We recommend writing to the budget up front — that, not the warning, is the real fix.